MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# CHICKEN AND NOODLES, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers chicken and noodles thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal specifications:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| TT-C-495 | - | Coatings, Exterior for Tinned Food Cans |
| PPP-B-636 | - | Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard |

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 8940

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Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit, Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification For

Military Standards;

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms

(Application for copies should be addressed to Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)



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Poultry Products Inspection Regulations (9 CFR 381)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Public Health Association

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1015 18th Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearney Street, #410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)



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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall be prepared from fresh chilled or frozen (ready-to-cook) fowl (mature female chicken). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate, certifying class and condition of product.

3.2.1.1 Chilled chicken. Chicken received in the chilled state shall not be previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 4 days following initial chilling and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate, certifying initial chilling date.

3.2.1.2 Frozen chicken. Raw (uncooked) chicken received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F for a period of time not to exceed 75 days following initial freezing and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate certifying the initial freezing (in-storage) date.

3.2.1.3 Precooked, frozen chicken. Pre-cooked, frozen, chicken mechanically diced with dice setting at approximately 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch may be purchased. In this case conditions in 3.2.1 and 3.2.1.1 shall apply prior to cooking. The cooked dices shall be frozen to 0°F within 72 hours, packaged and sealed in water impermeable material having an oxygen permeability of not more than 10cc of $O_2$ per square meter per 24 hours per mil thickness at 73°F and 0 percent relative humidity. The precooked frozen chicken dices shall be individually separable. The packaged frozen chicken dices shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 30 days prior to tray pack filling (see 3.4).

3.2.2 Chicken broth. Chicken broth may be purchased frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free with percent solids sufficient to comply with the solids requirement in the formulation. It shall have a characteristic mild chicken broth odor and flavor and may contain seasonings and flavor enhancers approved by the FDA. The chicken broth shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with the USDA regulations and when frozen shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to formulation.



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3.2.3 Chicken fat. Frozen chicken fat may be purchased. The chicken fat shall have a characteristic clear yellow color, chicken-fat odor and flavor. It may contain antioxidants approved by the FSIS of USDA. The chicken fat shall have a perioxide value not to exceed 6 meq/kg, a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.50 percent as oelic acid, and a moisture content not to exceed 0.25 percent. The chicken fat shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to sauce formulation (see 3.3.2).

3.2.4 Bay leaf, ground Ground bay leaf shall be derived from the dried leaves of Laurus nobilis L. It shall possess a pleasant aromatic odor and pungent, mildly bitter flavor with a pale green to yellow green color. A minimum of 95 percent shall pass through a US Standard No. 30 Sieve. Volatile oil content shall be not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground bay leaves.

3.2.5 Celery, soluble. Soluble celery flavoring shall be prepared by properly blending and dispersing a minimum of 4 percent of total extractives of the dried fruit of Apium graveolens L, on a soluble, dry, edible carrier. The flavoring shall possess a clean, celery-like aroma with a slightly bitter taste. It shall be free flowing, free from caking, and yellowish grey in color.

3.2.6 Dehydrate cheddar cheese. Dehydrated cheese shall be derived from U.S. Grade A or better sharp, aged cheddar cheese of the U.S. Standards for grades of Cheddar Cheese. The dehydrated cheese shall be uniform in composition and appearance, free from lumps that do not fall apart under light finger pressure and free from burnt specks and foreign material. The cheese shall be free from rancid, stale, oxidized, tallowy, fishy, soapy, scorched, or other objectionable flavors and odors. The dehydrated cheese shall contain not more than 3.0 percent moisture and 5.0 percent salt and not less than 48.0 percent milkfat. The color of the dehydrated cheese shall be within the range of No. 5 to No. 8 when compared to the National Cheese Institute Cheese Color reference Standards.

3.2.7 Starach, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized modified maize food starch for use in canned foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress and conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.8 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.



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3.2.9 Monosodium glutamate (MSG). Monosodium glutamate (MSG) shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.10 Mushrooms. Canned mushrooms stems and pieces style shall be U.S. Grade B or better in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms.

3.2.11 Egg noodles (fettuccini), enriched. The egg noodles shall meet the Standard of Identity for Enriched Egg Noodles. The egg noodles shall be clean, free from foreign material, and properly dried with no docking or cracking. The egg noodles shall have the following dimensions: length, 4.0 inches ± 0.5 (1/2) inch; width, 0.25 (1/4) inch ± 0.00625 )1/16) inch; thickness, 0.041 inch ± 0.005 inch. When tested in accordance with the "Official Methods of Analysis of the A.O.A.C", the egg noodles shall conform to the following analytical requirements: moisture, not greater than 13.00 percent; ash, not greater than 0.98 percent (moisture-free basis); protein, not less than 13.00 percent (moisture-free basis); egg solids, not less than 5.50 percent; lipid phosphorus, not less than 0.136 percent if prepared with egg yolk solids; not less than 0.101 percent if prepared with whole egs.

3.2.12 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or outer and inner coverings have been removed. The pepper shall have a characteristic penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.13 Shortening, vegetable, powdered. Powdered vegetable shortening shall spray dried, free flowing, and free from burnt or scorched aroma. It shall be composed of partially hydrogenated vegetable oil, sodium caseinate, corn syrup solids, soy protein isolate, dipotassium phosphate, sodium silico aluminate, tricalcium phosphate with or without antioxidants. The shortening shall meet the following chemical analysis: Total oil 75 ± 2.5 percent; protein 5.5 ± 0.5 percent; pH 7.5 ± 0.5; moisture 1.5 ± 0.5 percent; carbohydrate 16 ± 1.0 percent; ash 2.0 ± 1.0 percent.

3.2.14 Sugar granulated. Sugar shall be white, refined, sucrose, granlated cane or beet or combination of both and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.15 Onions, chopped, dehydrated. The dehydrated chopped onions shall be Fancy Grade as defined in the Official Standards and Methods of the Americam Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

3.2.16 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.



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3.2.17 Pre-blended spice and seasoning mixture. Pre-blended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and further processing.

3.3.1 Preparation of the chicken. The chicken shall be processed as follows:

a. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless and trimmed of all tendons, cartilage, large blood vessels, blood clots, discolorations, bruises, blemishes, feathers and hair. The chicken shall consist by weight of not less than 50 percent but not more than 60 percent white meat and not less than 40 percent but not more than 50 percent dark meat and shall be cooked by water cooking, roasting or steaming. The broth for cooking the chicken may be used in the sauce preparation in the amount and in compliance with the solids content as required.

b. The cooked chicken shall be cooled to 40°F or below immediately following the cooking process and held at that temperature or lower for not longer than 48 hours prior to filling.

c. The cooked chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch.

3.3.2 Sauce preparation. The sauce shall be formulated as follows:

| Ingredient | Percent |
|---|---|
| Chicken broth (3 to 3.5 percent solids) | 78.06 |
| Mushrooms, stems, pieces and caps, drained | 6.95 |
| Cheddar cheese (dehydrated) | 5.55 |
| Starch, modified, high opacity | 4.10 |
| Powdered vegetable shortening | 2.10 |
| Chicken fat | 2.00 |
| Sugar, white | 0.50 |
| Onion, chopped, dehydrated | 0.40 |
| Monosodium glutamate | 0.15 |
| Celery, soluble | 0.09 |
| Pepper, white, ground | 0.05 |
| Garlic powder | 0.04 |
| Bay leaf, ground | 0.01 |
| | 100.00 |



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a. A slurry shall be made with the starch and part of the chicken broth. Combine and mix the remaining ingredients except spices. Heat the mixture to 140° to 150°F combine the starch slurry and spices. The final mixture shall be heated to 180° to 190°F and held for approximately 5 minutes at this temperature.

b. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

c. The sauce shall be filled within 4 hours after cooking. The temperature of the prepared sauce shall be held at 150° to 180°F until filling into the can.

3.3.3 Preparation of noodles. The noodles shall be blanched in hot water until doubled in weight. If the blanched noodles are not filled into the tray cans immediately after blanching they shall be cooled rapidly to 45°F or lower by washing with cold water.

3.3.4 Product preparation. The chicken and noodles shall be prepared as follows:

a. The chicken, sauce, and noodles shall be gently mixed in the following proportions so that the ingredients will be evenly mixed in the tray cans:

| Ingredients | Percent |
|---|---|
| Chicken 1/ | 34.0 |
| Noodles, blanched | 9.0 |
| Sauce | 57.0 |
| | 100.0 |

1/ Light (white) chicken meat - not less than 50 percent and not more than 60 percent. Dark chicken meat - not less than 40 percent and not more than 50 percent.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. The temperature of the chicken at time of filling shall not exceed 40°F.
b. The temperature of the noodles at time of filling shall not exceed 40°F unless filling of trays occur immediately after blanching.
c. Each can shall be hermetically sealed (under a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury) immediately after filling.



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3.5 Tray pack thermostabilizing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 240°F or below until a sterilization value ($F_o$) of not less than 6.0 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not restricted to glass, paint, metal, dirt, insect, insect parts, hair, wood, or paper.

b. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not restricted to rancid, scorched, burnt, stale, sour, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no bone pieces measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

e. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

f. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

g. There shall be no cartilage, coarse connective tissue, or section of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

h. There shall be no pieces of skin, blood clot, bruises, or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

i. Not less than 27.0 ounces of recognizable chicken dices shall be retained on a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve.

j. No individual can shall contain less than 20.0 ounces of drained noodles.

k. Texture of chicken dices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

l. Texture of mushrooms shall not be mushy or tough.

m. The sauce shall have a smooth (not lumpy) consistency without being excessively thick or thin.

n. The average fat content shall be not greater than 7.5 percent.

o. The fat content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 9.0 percent.



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p. The salt content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 1.0 percent.

3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture. The dehydrated cheese and the natural cheddar cheese from which the dehydrated cheese originated shall be produced and stored in plants approved by the Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or other applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each



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ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 empty tray pack cans and lids and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. Eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. The eight tray packs shall be heated for 35 minutes in 180° to 190°F water, opened, and inspected in accordance with table I.

a. If no defects are found, the lot shall be acceptable.

b. If two or more major defects are found, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If only one major defect is found, a second sample of eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot, heated as above, and inspected for the defects indicated in table I. If any defect is found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE I. Product inspection 1/ 2/

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 151 | Presence of bone measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension. |
| 152 | Presence of cartilage or sections of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension. |



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TABLE I. Product inspection 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| 153 | Presence of skin, blood clots, bruise or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension. |
| 154 | Drained weight of recognizable chicken dices in a can is less than 27.0 ounces. 3/ |
| 155 | Drained weight of noodles in a can is less than 20.0 ounces. 3/ |
| 156 | Texture of chicken dices dry, rubbery, or mushy. 4/ |
| 157 | Texture of mushrooms mushy or tough. |
| 158 | Color not characteristic of the product (materially darkened, scorched, or oxidized). |
| 159 | Sauce consistency not smooth (lumpy) or is excessively thick or thin. |

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.) foreign odor or flavor (e.g burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee or a Poultry Grading Branch representative.)

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated such as to liquify rendered fat and to remove the sauce without breaking the chicken dices or noodles. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4-inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the chicken dices or noodles. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at an approximate 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes. Record the gross weight of the chicken dices



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and noodles. Remove the chicken dices. Reweigh and record the gross weight of the noodles. Subtract sieve tare weight to calculate the drained weight of chicken dices and noodles and report to the nearest 0.1 ounce. After the drained weight of the chicken dices and noodles has been attained, remove chicken dices and reweigh. The drained weights shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ Examination for chicken dice texture conformance shall be made of representative chicken dices immediately following the test for drained weight (see footnote 3/).

4.6.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray packs shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

-Three for laboratory analysis.
-Three for submission to the contractor.
-Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows. The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs is greater than 7.5 percent.
b. The fat content in any individual tray pack is greater than 9.0 percent.
c. The salt content in any individual tray pack is greater than 1.0 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserved sample is analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.



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4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used; (4) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above the top edge of box; (5) Length or width of pads less than box dimensions by more than 1/8 inch; (6) Arrangement or number of cans not as specified. Level C containers shall be examined as specified above, except that reinforcement defect is not applicable.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of the food product, sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4, 3.5 and 3.6. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect or be affected by the packaged product. A COC shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).



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5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The can shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be fabricated of the same material as the box and positioned as specified in 5.2.1. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch the full length and width dimensions of the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each package shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be permanently marked or stamped, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.7 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:



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TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving. Caution: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

WARNING: Do not place closed cans in oven, as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Twelve (12) servings (1 cup per serving)

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).



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6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030-33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A442



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DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
US Army Natick Research and Development Center
Natick, Massachusetts 01760



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# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

*(See Instructions – Reverse Side)*

| 1. DOCUMENT NUMBER | 2. DOCUMENT TITLE |
|---|---|
| PP-C-002200(Army-GL) | Chicken and Noodles, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack |

| 3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION | 4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)* |
|---|---|
| | ☐ VENDOR |
| b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* | ☐ USER |
| | ☐ MANUFACTURER |
| | ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____ |

**5. PROBLEM AREAS**

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

**6. REMARKS**

| 7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional | b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional |
|---|---|
| c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional | 8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)* |

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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